Pablo: A Volunteer Evacuation Driver

Filmed in April 2022, during the war in Ukraine, after a Shiftwave session

After Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine on February 24, 2022, volunteer drivers carried civilians out of areas under attack.

What These Drivers Faced

- **Day and night driving.** According to Mike North, Ph.D., Shiftwave Co-Founder, Inventor and CEO, who filmed the video, Pablo had been "driving day and night all over Ukraine, going right into the front lines and evacuating women and children and orphans." According to Mike North, the drivers had evacuated 9,000 kids so far.
- **Large numbers of people.** Drivers from one Ukrainian group, Proliska, helped 5,300 civilians evacuate from the east by July 2022 (UN OCHA). In May 2022, one volunteer hub in Odesa had about 5,500 people on its waiting list to leave Kherson (BBC).
- **Long waits and danger on the road.** One driver described stopping during shelling and waiting "an hour or two" before he could drive again, on mined roads and over destroyed bridges (UN OCHA). Another described reaching a checkpoint at 05:00 and waiting until evening (BBC).
- **Real risk.** In May 2022, five volunteer drivers and staff were reported missing or captured after evacuation buses entered one front-line town (BBC). Other volunteer drivers were shelled or shot while evacuating civilians (BBC).
- **Little sleep, constant stress.** Mike North said of the drivers: "They're just not getting any sleep, they're totally stressed out, and they're being exposed to trauma themselves." A coordinator of the Odesa drivers told the BBC: "I don't sleep. I feel like I can't breathe out until the drivers are back."

What Happened When Pablo Used Shiftwave

Mike North filmed Pablo right after a session. Pablo spoke in Russian and Ukrainian, translated here.

> "Stress, yes. It's gone. The stress is leaving."
>
> Pablo, asked how he feels

> "My head is freeing up. It was clenched, it was tight."
>
> Pablo

> "It will be a great help for our guys, who are saving people, who are saving children."
>
> Pablo, on the other drivers

> "They need some serious on-demand R&R."
>
> Mike North

Why It Matters for US Truckers

- **The same core demands.** Long hours, irregular sleep, and hours of focus behind the wheel are part of every professional driver's job. These drivers faced them at the extreme.
- **Stress builds up.** Pablo described his head as "clenched" and "tight" before his session. Many drivers know that feeling at the end of a long haul.
- **Recovery has to fit the job.** With evacuations running day and night, a reset had to happen between runs, right where the drivers were.
- **Drivers look out for each other.** Pablo's first thought after his session was for the other drivers: "This will be a big help for our guys."

Watch the 72-second video with English subtitles:
gordonshiftwave.github.io/shiftwave-ukrainian-memos-en/ukrainian-rescue-truck-drivers/

Pablo's words were translated from Russian and Ukrainian. These are one driver's personal experiences, not medical claims. Sources: UN OCHA, "Ukraine: Driving civilians out of the danger zone," July 12, 2022; BBC News, "Ukraine war: The volunteer drivers risking their lives to save others," May 20, 2022; BBC News, "Donbas fighting: Risking capture to evacuate the vulnerable from the front line," May 5, 2022.